

LIVE

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NEWSPAPER

3th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

27th WEEK



GERMANY... SAME SEX MARRIAGE

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.

5

The Merkel manoeuvre

She allowed the vote on same-sex marriage while personally opposing it

RADHIKA SANTHANAM



In a historic vote on June 30, the German Parliament approved same-sex marriage even as German Chancellor Angela Merkel voted against it. "Marriage is between a man and a woman," she said, adding, "I hope that the vote today not only promotes respect between different opinions but also brings more social cohesion and peace."

Despite her personal reservations, it was a statement by Ms. Merkel earlier in the week that triggered the vote. At a talk organised by woman's magazine *Brigitte*, she was forced to confront an issue that she has long been avoiding. "When do I get to call my boyfriend my husband?" a young man asked her. In response, she recounted how moving it was for her to see a lesbian couple take care of eight foster children. "It is a question of conscience rather than something that I push through with a majority vote," she said. Martin Schulz, leader of the Social Democratic Party that is in coalition with Ms. Merkel's Christian Democratic Union and who is her main opponent in the forthcoming election, immediately seized upon this statement to fulfil his own campaign promise. "We will push through marriage equality in Germany," he tweeted. "This week."

The legislation may seem surprising in its swiftness "but it wasn't unexpected", said Gabriela Luensmann, board member of the Lesbian and Gay Federation in Germany and a human rights lawyer. "We've been campaigning for 25 years now. It's finally time to celebrate."

It has taken a surprisingly long time for Germany, a country with a thriving LGBTQ culture, to reach this stage. Pressure has always been there: 13 other countries in Europe, including Ireland, a staunchly Catholic nation, have already legalised same-sex marriage. And it is not as though the German public was opposed to it. In January, Germany's Anti-Discrimination Agency found that an overwhelming 83% of Germans support same-sex marriage. Politicians across parties too have always spoken in favour of it.

THE  HINDU

Date : 3rd July, 2017

AS PER THE ARTICLE



Angela Merkel
Chancellor of Germany

- 1** *In a historic vote, the German Parliament has approved the same sex marriage.*
- 2** *German Chancellor Angela Merkel voted against it.*
- 3** *However, the vote in Parliament not only promotes respect between different opinions, but also brings more social cohesion and peace.*
- 4** *The Country has got thriving LGBTQ culture.*
- 5** *However, it took surprisingly long time for Germany to reach this stage*
- 6** *13 other countries in Europe, including Ireland have already legalised the same sex marriage.*

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